

# Vinay Degavath

Director of Product | Fintech · Lending · AI

IIT Kharagpur | Token 2049 Speaker

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## SUMMARY

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Product leader, 13+ years fintech/DeFi/AI. Head of Product at Finin — neobank acquired by Open (employee #2). Founded Hashstack (DeFi lending; autonomous risk; 16-person eng). Side project: AI product strategy from domain expertise (pre-ship).

## EXPERIENCE

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### Hashstack Finance

2020 – 2026

Founder & CEO — [hashstack.finance](#)

Bengaluru

- Designed autonomous risk framework for under-collateralized lending — zero credit committee; solvency via smart-contract constraints
- Shipped [Degen Mode](#) — one-click leveraged execution with capital locked to approved deployment channels
- Built [DIAL](#) (v1); learned complexity/audit cost weren't justified — production [IRM](#) (v2) = kinked utilization curve
- Led product across eng, community, BD (16-person team). Deprioritized exchange listing for platform security — [CertiK](#) audit
- Raised \$2M total (\$1M public seed + private funding); 36,000 on-chain users at \$55/user and \$56K+ first-year revenue (*operator metrics*); 61% avg utilization (*operator metric*). 180K STRK + \$50K Harmony grants. Authored proposed [EIP-5299](#)
- Orchestrated 7 financial infrastructure integrations for pricing, liquidity, and risk data. Published 2 technical whitepapers
- Led structured wind-down after ecosystem adoption lagged and migration ROI turned negative; second-chain deploy validated portability

### Finin

Oct 2019 – Jul 2020

Head of Product — [acquired by Open Financial Technologies](#)

Bengaluru

- Employee #2; grew engineering 0→16 through product-market fit
  - Designed and shipped neobank core banking (KYC → savings → cards) with State Bank of Mauritius as banking partner; product scope shaped by RBI digital-banking constraints
  - Built unified transactional intelligence via account aggregators, surfaced in-app
  - Acquired 5,000 savings accounts via product-led growth (*operator metric*)
  - Company acquired by Open — validated PMF ([TechCrunch](#))

### Parashar

2024 – Present

Product & AI (*Side Project, pre-ship*)

- Defined product vision, scoped systems to encode vs defer, designed end-to-end UX
  - Translated domain rules into AI training requirements and evaluation criteria

*Managing Partner — [guardrail.fund](https://guardrail.fund)*

- Conviction-driven single-family office; 10+ year horizon
  - Sourced deal flow; market theses for early-stage digital assets (2017–2019). Angel investor in [Gushwork](#) (\$9M seed)

## Earlier Experience

*Echo · Qulp · AIESEC*

- **Echo** (Co-founder, 2016–2017) — Location-based social discovery. Facebook FBSTART. SURGE 2016. 3,000 users. #13 India Play Store, zero marketing spend
- **Qulp** (Founder, 2013–2015) — Hardware innovation platform. Google Launchpad 2014. TiE Asia regional finalists 2014. \$60K in pre-orders. Team of 7
- **AIESEC IIT Kharagpur** (VP Marketing & PR, 2010–2013) — Led 13-person team across promotions, branding, and media. 1st place, Nokia–AIESEC India campaign

## PUBLISHED WORK & SPEAKING

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[EIP-5299: Proposed Layer3 scaling EIP](#) — [discussion](#)

[Published](#) [whitepaper](#) on [lending protocol architecture](#)

[DIAL: Dynamic Interest Algorithm \(v1\)](#) — [Interest Rate Model \(v2\)](#)

[Speaker](#), [Token 2049](#) (2022)

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

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Python · SQL · TypeScript · JavaScript · Amplitude · Mixpanel · Figma · Jira/Linear · Notion · API Design · Data Modeling · GitHub

## EDUCATION

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**Indian Institute of Technology, Kharagpur**